Waste & Circular Economy Daily Briefing — November 13, 2026

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The takeaway Wood Buffalo is carrying its lower curbside waste rate into 2027 after the shift to producer-funded residential recycling, while landfill drop-off fees are still under review.

At a glance

- Wood Buffalo's current landfill fee waiver covers up to 200 kg of household waste per residence per day through March 31, 2027.
- Ontario's environment minister said he would consider alternatives to the proposed repeal of the municipal support requirement for new large landfills.
- A food-waste study found that methane potential varied by feedstock source in laboratory tests.

Wood Buffalo carries its lower curbside rate into 2027

In its November 12 announcement on the next fee bylaw, the Regional Municipality of Wood Buffalo said the **$25 monthly residential waste rate** will carry forward in Fort McMurray's Urban Service Area, Draper, Saprae Creek Estates, Anzac and Gregoire Lake Estates. Council approved the reduction in October after producers took on residential recycling. The previous rate in Fort McMurray's Urban Service Area was $43 per dwelling per month. November 12 municipal announcement and October rate change.

At the Regional Landfill, a separate fee waiver covers up to 200 kg of household waste per residence per day through March 31, 2027. The municipality is reviewing what to charge when the new bylaw takes effect April 1. Municipal fee schedule.

Calgary firefighters contain a recycling equipment fire

Calgary firefighters responded around 7:25 a.m. on November 12 to a warehouse on 24 Street SE. The fire was contained to a recycling hopper, and no injuries were reported. A fire investigator classified the incident as unintentional and separate from September's landfill fire at the site. Calgary Fire Department.

Ontario minister signals room for changes to landfill proposal

In an interview published November 12 by The Globe and Mail, Ontario Environment Minister Todd McCarthy said he was open to changes to the proposed repeal of the municipal support requirement for new large landfills. The Globe and Mail interview.

The text of Bill 140 still proposes to repeal section 17.5 of the Environmental Assessment Act. That section requires support from host municipalities and qualifying neighbouring municipalities before proponents can submit a comprehensive environmental assessment to the minister. Ontario's proposal would remove that prerequisite, and municipalities could still comment during the assessment. The bill was referred to committee on November 2.

Assembly bill status, Bill 140, Schedule 7 and Ontario's proposal.

Watch next The Environmental Registry consultation on landfill capacity and diversion closes November 26. Watch the committee text for any change to the municipal support requirement. Environmental Registry of Ontario.

Research spotlight · Estimate methane potential by food-waste source

In a study published online September 26, Nabulime and colleagues sampled food waste from grocery stores, restaurants, schools and landfill-bound residential waste. The abstract reports the highest laboratory methane potential for grocery waste and the lowest for residential samples. The assays measure how much methane the samples could yield under test conditions. Actual digester output depends on the feedstock and operating conditions. For a Bow Valley feasibility study, keep grocery, food-service and residential samples separate when measuring local feedstock potential. Bioresource Technology abstract.